

**Board 1**

West Deals  
None Vul

♠ 9 7 5 4  
♥ 10 6  
♦ J 7 2  
♣ 8 6 5 3

♠ A J 10  
♥ A K 9 8 5  
♦ K 9 6  
♣ Q 7



♠ K Q 2  
♥ Q J 4 2  
♦ 10 8 5 3  
♣ 9 2

♠ 8 6 3  
♥ 7 3  
♦ A Q 4  
♣ A K J 10 4

| <i>West</i> | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|-------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
| Pass        | 1 ♥          | Pass        | 2 ♣          |
| Pass        | 2NT          | Pass        | 3NT          |
| Pass        | 4NT          | Pass        | 6NT          |
| All Pass    |              |             |              |

North opens 1 ♥ - how should you respond? North rebids 2NT. How do you continue? South shows her minimum by bidding 3NT. North continues with 4NT - what does this mean? How do you continue?

North's 4NT was not Blackwood, but rather a quantitative raise in Notrump, and an invitation to slam. You have 15 points, and they are good ones. So you accept the invitation and bid 6NT. There are 11 top tricks. A 3-3 ♥ split would provide the 12th winner, but this is against the odds. Better to try two ♠ finesses, a 75% chance.

**Board 3**

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 6 3  
 ♥ Q 3  
 ♦ A K J 9 4  
 ♣ 9 6 4

♠ K 10  
 ♥ 9 8 7 6 2  
 ♦ 10 7 2  
 ♣ A K 2



♠ A J 8 7 5 2  
 ♥ A K  
 ♦ Q 6  
 ♣ J 8 7

♠ 9 4  
 ♥ J 10 5 4  
 ♦ 8 5 3  
 ♣ Q 10 5 3

East opens 1♠ - You responds 2♦, natural and game forcing. East rebids 2♠. In our style of 2/1, this promises 6+ cards in spades, and denies a side 4-card suit. What should we bid now?

You should jump to 4♠. This is Fast Arrival, indicating a minimum hand with no particular interest in slam. East is happy to rest in the game contract. Even with a combined 30 points, 10 tricks are certainly not a sure thing. East must hope that North holds the trump King.

| <i>West</i> | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|-------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|             | Pass         | 1♠          | Pass         |
| 2♦          | Pass         | 2♠          | Pass         |
| 4♠          |              |             |              |
| All Pass    |              |             |              |